

1920x1080

The resolution of the World's largest OLED display, from Samsung.

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display is Rs 2,59,900 which is frankly a little more than what we would expect to pay but its also comparable to Philips' offering which brings us to one conclusion — 52-inch LCD displays are overpriced as of now and we suggest you wait a bit if you want something in this size category.

Samsung LA- 40A650: Expensive real estate

The LA-40A650 is a 40-inch LCD display and looks neat. The entire back is plastic and matte black. The front bezel is piano-finished in black and is translucent. This bezel has red implants all through it and this gives it a reddish tinge in certain



Samsung LA- 40A650

areas and since the amount of red varies so does the colour tone. Weirdly there are no buttons on the body of the display but the remote unit looks very neat and has a good range; buttons also work well and we didn't have the sporadic issues with keys not working when being pressed that plagued some of the other remote units. This unit has all the important connects and even the cable port had RCA ports for outputting to auxiliary speakers.

Post calibration we ran into issues under Display Mate first; this display totally missed out on the three highest intensities and all three bands looked identical. This problem also cropped up during the movie tests. We found places where there were smudges of red instead of smooth transitions in the colours intensity that are expected. Although this isn't serious enough of an issue to ruin the experience of watching movies we found it a little annoying. Other than that this display gave good performance with contrast and colouring throughout the movie tests and works with lower resolution content quite well. Text rendition is sharp and this display will satisfy even if it's being used as a substitute monitor.

Priced at Rs 1,07,000 the LA-40A650 is expensive — especially when you consider that other 42-inch displays are available at much lower prices. We can't recommend paying more for less, so don't bust your wallet here.

LG 42-LG80FR: Beautiful stranger

This was perhaps one of the most attractive looking displays we received. Its finished

in a glossy black fibre that has embedded red highlights that give certain parts of the bezel an almost red-wine like colour. The rear is plastic too, but finished well and nothing looks cheap. This display has retractable speakers that can be set to retract when it's powered off or they can be left extruded permanently. The motor assembly for the speakers is very silent and we played around with this gimmicky addition for a few minutes. And it turns out this isn't another useless add-on; the larger speakers are pretty powerful too, although to be honest they are nowhere close to even a cursory speaker system. Even the remote unit looks attractive with a matte-finish; it works flawlessly too. Unfortunately the stand is not very stable and we could actually tilt the display 10 degrees forward and backward with the stand affixed; LG needs to work on the stand before we deem this acceptable — for now its definitely not.

In terms of performance the 42-LG80FR is a scorcher. It did well across the board with Display Mate with good rendition of colours and a good contrast ratio. Throughout our movie tests we had no colour aberrations or any sort of problems.



It does excellently well with 1080p content and even displays lower resolution stuff well. Text rendition is clear, crisp and with great detail making



LG 42-LG80FR

reading even long documents a pleasure. If you want to use your display as a monitor or even to read the odd e-book this display should be at the top of your priority list. It's a superb all rounder and at a price of Rs 83,000 its reasonably affordable. This display was our (joint) Digit Best Performance winner and comes highly recommended for anyone shopping for a 42-inch LCD display.

Hitachi P50-X01AU: Industrial grade beauty

The P50-X01AU is one of the older models in test. In fact its date of manufacture indicates it was made in 2007, which means it was probably lying around in some warehouse for a good many months.

Nevertheless it's a very clean looking display and has a very rugged industrial-grade look to it. The rear is metal, unlike plastic that is favoured by most other vendors. The outer portion of the front bezel is finished in brushed aluminum while the inner portion is finished with a mock glass sort of finish. The speakers are very cleverly integrated into the front bezel and you won't feel that they have been added later — great design here. The middle portion of the bottom of the bezel consists of a flap that is flush fitting with the rest of the bezel and opens to reveal an HDMI port, a 3.5mm jack, composite



Hitachi P50-X01AU

port and the menu and volume buttons. We welcome the inclusion of a front HDMI port because of the convenience offered. Even more welcome is a headphone jack on the front panel. The panel being a plasma display is hard glass and gloss-finished. There is some sort of surface treatment that has been done because despite the fact that the panel is glossy there is minimal reflection. Hitachi has also done well with the stand; it's not large, but is ultra stable and the pivot action is very smooth.

Being an older display when we connected it to our test PC using D-Sub connectivity the maximum resolution we could get was 1280 x 1024 pixels. While there was no serious issue with any of the Display Mate tests we were not fully satisfied with this displays performance in all of the tests. The colours are not bad, but could have better while the same can be said for the contrast ratio and moiré tests.

With movies the P50-X01AU is good with 1080p content, but it does not scale well with lower resolution stuff. Text resolution is decent but should have been better before we recommend you using this as a monitor. DVD movies also have issues, presumably because they are not of the panels' native resolution. This, it seems is the major issue with this display — it doesn't do very well with non-native resolution content. For Rs 1,35,000 the P50-X01AU is expensive for a plasma display and not recommended by us for any usage pattern.